Team number: 012-1
Team name: Budget Squad
Team members:

- Saanvi Trivedi
- Ian Sobiech
- Akhil Sunkara
- Eesha Sivakumar
- David Pelphrey
- Abdul Hakeem

Application name: Flash Financial Savings

Application description:

The app will take in users' spending data and categorize their expenses into different categories, such as groceries, dining, transportation, entertainment, and bills. Based on their spending habits, it will create a flexible, personalized budget that adapts to their financial situation, goals, and changing expenses rather than forcing them to follow a rigid spending plan.

The app will also provide personalized recommendations to help users save money and make smarter financial decisions. By analyzing spending patterns, it can identify areas where users could reduce expenses and suggest realistic ways to save. Additionally, the app will use an external API to compare prices across different providers and identify affordable options for products and services, helping users find the best price points while staying within their budget.

Audience:

The target audience for our application is younger consumers, particularly college students and young adults living in urban areas who frequently shop online and spend money on consumer goods but struggle to manage their spending and stay within a budget. These users often have busy schedules, numerous shopping opportunities, and limited experience with personal financial management, making it difficult to balance their spending habits with their savings goals. Our application aims to solve this problem by providing an accessible, flexible budgeting tool that categorizes expenses, tracks spending, and offers personalized recommendations to help users save money and find affordable purchasing options. To meet the needs of this audience, the application will be available online and feature a simple, intuitive interface that makes budgeting quick and convenient, even for busy students. Its modern, engaging design will appeal to younger users while ensuring that the features remain easy to navigate and accessible to people with varying levels of financial knowledge.

Vision statement:

For young consumers, especially college students and young adults who frequently shop online and struggle to manage their spending, who need a simple and flexible way to budget, track expenses, and save money, the Budget Buddy is a personalized budgeting application that categorizes spending, adapts to users' financial habits, and

recommends affordable products and services to help them make smarter financial decisions. Unlike traditional budgeting apps that rely on rigid budgets and basic expense tracking, our product combines flexible budgeting, personalized savings recommendations, and external price-comparison data in a very accessible, easy, user-friendly platform designed to make managing money simple and engaging for younger consumers.

Development Methodology:

- Agile Methodology

Communication Plan:

- Slack

Meeting Plan:

- Group meeting: Tuesday 5:30 PM
- TA meeting: Wednesday 4:45-5:00 PM online

Risk prevention:

Potential risk	Severity	Mitigation Strategy
Data Privacy and Security: The application may handle sensitive financial information, putting users at risk if their data is exposed or stolen.	High	Encrypt sensitive data, use secure authentication, limit data collection, and follow established security and privacy practices.
2. Inaccurate Spending Categorization: The application may incorrectly categorize transactions, leading to inaccurate budgets and misleading recommendations.	Medium	Use reliable categorization methods, allow users to manually edit categories, and provide an option to correct mistakes.
3. External API Failures: Price-comparison APIs may become unavailable, return outdated information, or provide incomplete pricing data.	Medium	Use reliable APIs, verify the freshness of price data, implement error handling, and provide alternative recommendations when the API is unavailable.
4. Low User Engagement: Young consumers may stop using	High	Design an intuitive interface, simplify budget setup, provide

the application if budgeting feels time-consuming, repetitive, or unhelpful.		personalized insights, and use optional progress tracking to encourage continued engagement.
5. Inaccurate Savings Recommendations: Recommendations may not account for a user's actual needs, financial priorities, or personal circumstances.	Medium	Allow users to customize their financial goals, explain why recommendations are made, and let users adjust or dismiss suggestions.

Case Diagram:

